

How to Play

Your Goal is to Out-joust the Opposing Wizard

As a frail wizard, they only have one hit point. Unfortunately, you *also* are a frail wizard. To win, you simply need to beat through your opponent's defenses and reduce that one hit point to zero.

Set Up

To play Wizard Jousting, you will need a friend, and each of you will need a library containing 40 spell cards, a 10 spell card reserve, and a class card. First, decide who gets the first turn (the 'prep turn') with a sufficiently random competition. Then you each shuffle your reserve and your library. Draw a hand of 5 cards from your library, then you may put any number of cards on the bottom of your library, drawing back up to 5. Finally, the prep turn player puts two cards from their hand onto the bottom of their library, and play begins!

You may have up to 3 copies of a card in your decklist (between both your library and reserve) before the game begins. Libraries and reserves can be made up of generic cards and cards that share a school of magic with the class card, as denoted by the bookmark's color and shape.

Taking Turns

The structure of a turn is broken into three phases: Start, Main, and End. During the Start of the turn you trigger all triggered effects that happen at the start of the turn. Then, during the Main of the turn, you may play any spells that you wish. When you're done for the turn, you move to the End where all triggered effects that happen at the end of turn trigger. At the end of the End, if you have less than 5 cards in hand, draw cards from the top of your library until you have 5. If instead you didn't play any cards during your turn and have 5 or more cards in hand, discard one or more cards first then draw up to hand size. Players cannot be targeted until that player has completed a turn.

Anatomy of a Spell Card



In wizard jousting, spell cards can be broken down into 8 main parts.

1. Name. It's what the spell is called.
2. Pitch value. This is the value that a card can contribute to a spell's cost when you pitch it.
3. Cost Bookmark. This is how much pitch value a spell requires to be cast. The color and shape of the bookmark also indicates the class type. You may only have cards that either match the bookmark of your class card or cards with the generic bookmark, as seen on Ax.
4. Art box. Here you can draw custom art for your spell cards.
5. Card type. This indicates the type of spell that you're casting. It doesn't have any inherent effect on a card's function, but can interact with cards that ask for a certain type of card.
6. Text box. This is where the magic happens! Once you successfully cast a spell, the effects, or things that it does, are listed here.
7. Stability. This is how much damage a spell can take before it's sent to the dustbin (face-down). If a spell ever has 0 stability remaining, it is discarded once all effects and abilities are resolved.
8. Set Info. Here's where you can find out a spell's ID and rarity.

Casting a Spell

You can cast any spells in your hand during your turn by pitching **visible** cards you own. To do so, show your opponent the cards you want to use to cast the spell with total pitch value greater than or equal to the spell's cost from among your visible cards, place them into your dustbin (face-down), and put the spell into play. Before anything else can be done, the spell's cast effects (Any text that doesn't have a cost or triggering condition) are put onto the stack. Cast effects on the stack can be responded to with swift spells. Once both players are satisfied, the effects resolve in first in, last out order.

What is a visible card?

Cards are visible if they're in your hand or if they're public information to all players. This includes cards revealed from libraries and cards in play, but wouldn't include cards that you can see from searching your library or simply looking at the top two cards.

(As a rule of thumb, cards are visible if they're in your hand or face-up on the board in front of you. For example, cards in your dustbin, reserve, and library are not visible because those zones are played face-down. Additionally, cards under or covered by other cards would not be visible, while cards attached to other cards would be.)

For Example...



1. It's your opponent's turn. Your opponent has a previously cast Pinprick in play, and a hand containing Eldritch Blast and Wind Wall. You have a previously cast Summon Squirrel, and a Counterspell in hand.
2. Your opponent shows you the Wind Wall in their hand and the Pinprick in play, with a total pitch value of 4, putting them face down in their dustbin to cast the 3 cost Eldritch Blast, targeting you.
3. You respond to the spell's effect by casting Counterspell, pitching your Summon Squirrel.
4. Both players have no more actions, so the Counterspell counters the Eldritch Blast's effect and breaks it, sending it to the dustbin.
5. Your opponent ends the turn and draws up to five cards.



Other Effects

If a card simply has text without any conditions, this is a cast effect and it happens when the spell is cast. However, some cards can do things at points other than when they're cast. If a card's effect has a triggering condition, it is considered a triggered effect. Do it whenever that condition (trigger) arises. If the effect instead has a cost, denoted by a colon (:), you may use that effect during your turn, as long as you pay the required cost and there's no other effects to resolve. This is called an activated effect. Activated effects can also provide alternative times and places to be activated.

Ending the game

All good things must come to an end eventually. Once all effects and abilities are resolved, if a player has 0 hit points, the opposing player wins! Additionally, if a player runs out of spells in their library and they go to draw a card, they lose.

The Pace of Play

Because you re-draw your entire hand at the end of each turn, it's generally beneficial to put as much material on the board as you can. Even if a card isn't particularly useful currently, you're storing its pitch value for later use. Pitching cards off of the board can allow you to do more than you could with a single hand.

Swift cards, which you can use on other players' turns, are extremely valuable for this reason. If an opponent tries to destroy some of your cards, you can reactively pitch them into a spell, causing the

opponent's spell to fizzle. This is a fundamental part of the gameplay, you can force an opponent into action by attempting to take away their resources.

If you spend the entire game just trying to damage your opponent, they'll have so many spells, abilities, and supplies available to them that your efforts won't get far. (Especially because players are usually tougher than their spells.)

Usually, you'll want to build up a board full of high-pitch cards and activated abilities, which you can use to create a barrage of attacks that may win the game in a single turn.

Keywords

For the sake of keeping card text simple, some concepts are reduced to keywords. Those keywords are listed below.

Aegis

If damage would be dealt to you, you may instead have that damage be dealt to an aegis spell. If you control multiple aegis spells, choose one of them for an instance of damage to be dealt to. Damage can only be redirected this way if the spell has greater than 0 stability.

Archive

Archiving a card is an action where you move a card from its current zone to memory. Cards in memory are placed under their owner's class.

Collapsing

If a collapsing spell would take damage exceeding its current stability, the excess damage is re-assigned to you.

Demanding

Spells that are Demanding can only be included in a library or reserve if the full list meets its demands. For example, Larvae from Beyond the Fold cannot be included in your library or moved there between games, as this would violate its demands.

Howl

When a card instructs you to howl, triggered effects that trigger “On Howl,” trigger.

Immutable

If a card is Immutable, you can't use it to pay for pitch costs. Immutable applies in every zone. It can still be discarded for other effects and broken as normal.

Instill

Forces the opponent to create a token. They are considered the caster of this token spell, and can activate its abilities and even use it to pitch for costs, assuming it doesn't have immutable.

Ritual

To perform a ritual, set the indicated number of cards in play aside into a ritual. This can be reused for other rituals of the same number, but not rituals of different numbers. If any spell in a ritual is broken, the ritual also breaks.

Search

To search a zone, look through it for the designated card or cards, then reveal it. When you finish searching, turn all face up cards in that zone face down, then shuffle.

Slip

To slip a card into play, put it into play without activating any of its cast effects.

Swap

Swapping cards is an action where you exchange two card's positions and states. Each card exchanges damage, attachments, zones, and facing. If an effect targeted one of the cards before swapping, it now targets the card that replaced it.

Swift

A swift spell can be cast at any time, not just during your turn.

Toll

A toll is a cost that must be paid in order to cast a spell.

Tokens

Tokens are spells created by other cards. Tokens are similarly left off the card text for simplicity. The table of tokens in the base set is provided here.

Acorn 1/-/1

Token Trinket

Burn -/-/1

Token Curse

Immutable

At the end of your turn, you and this token both take 1 damage.

Bury -/-/1

Token Curse

Immutable

Pitch 2: Break this token.

Contract -/-/1

Token Pact

Immutable

Search your reserve for a card and place it under this token.

When Contract is broken, add all cards under it to their owners hands.

Din 2/-/1

Token Hymn

Freeze -/-/1

Token Curse

Immutable

Pitch 2: Break this token.

Home 0/-/2

Token Place

Research 2/-/1

Token Transmutation

At the beginning of your turn, you may draw a card and break this spell.

Shield 1/-/1

Token Abjuration

Aegis

Squirrel 4/-/1

Token Summon

Sting 1/-/1

Token Evocation

Break this token: Deal 1 damage to any target.

Other Rulings

Covered Cards

- If a spell is covered, it is no longer considered a spell. Instead, it is simply a card.
- Covered cards cannot be targeted.
- Damage is still marked on covered cards.

Face Down Cards

- Face down cards are not considered spells.
- Typically, face down cards will be in play for a reason. In the case that their reason for being in play leaves play, such as a Larvae from Beyond the Fold breaking, the face down cards will remain.
- If face down cards were visible to you at any time since they were last shuffled, you may look at them at any time. For example, you could freely look at all spells under Larvae from Beyond the Fold, but not the cards under a Heretical Pact.
- You cannot cast face down spells you can't look at, regardless of their abilities.

Timing Rules

- Effects resolve in a stack, with a first in last out order.
- State changes, such as spells being broken as a result of having no stability and players losing the game, are checked every time the stack is emptied.

Miscellany

- Classes aren't in play. They only exist in memory.
- The four class categories have names. The green cards are primal, the dark blue cards are deep, the red cards are arcane, and the yellow cards are divine.
- When drawing or discarding a card from any pile or zone, use the top card. You cannot reorder a pile you draw from, even if its order is known information.
 - If you would draw or discard multiple cards from a pile, you may either do so one at a time or all at once.
- Tokens that can't be made in a specified condition won't be made. For example, if you cast Flash Freeze targeting a spell, and then that spell is pitched to a swift spell, the freeze token will not be instilled.
- Cast effects happen after the spell is in play. If there is no legal target, the cast effect will do nothing. Spells can target themselves. For example, playing Pinprick on an empty board will deal 1 damage to the pinprick, causing it to break when states are checked.
- The zones are as follows: library, reserve, dustbin, play, and memory
- The states are as follows: Face (as in up or down), Attached (As in attached to a spell, player, or other object), and Cover (covered or uncovered).
- Cards are only considered spells once in play.

- For the purposes of things that trigger when you cast a spell, if the card you cast ends up being a spell, it will trigger. If you manage to cast something that isn't a spell, you get a gold star!
- Spells without costs can't be cast.